



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD CATEGORY DETAILS

Herbs and spices (12.2.1)

Description:

Herbs and spices are usually derived from botanical sources, and may be dehydrated, and either ground or whole. Examples of herbs include basil, oregano and thyme. Examples of spices include cumin and caraway seeds. Spices may also be found as blends in powder or paste form.

This page provides information on the food additive provisions that are acceptable for use in foods conforming to the food category.

This food category is listed in the **Annex to Table 3**. Unless specifically indicated below, food additive provisions implied by **Table 3** do not automatically apply to this category, with the exception of spices to which the food additives provisions implied by Table 3 apply.

GSFA Provisions for Food Category 12.2.1

INS No.	Food Additive or Group	Max Level	Notes	Defined In
	ASCORBYL ESTERS	500 mg/kg	- Note XS343 - Note XS326 - Note XS351 - Note XS342 - Note 10 - Note XS347 - Note XS327 - Note XS345 - Note XS344 - Note XS328 - Note XS352 - Note XS353	12.2
320	Butylated hydroxyanisole (BHA)	200 mg/kg	- Note XS343 - Note XS326 - Note XS351 - Note 15 - Note XS342 - Note 130 - Note XS347 - Note XS327 - Note XS345 - Note XS344 - Note XS328 - Note XS352 - Note XS353	12.2
321	Butylated hydroxytoluene (BHT)	200 mg/kg	- Note XS343 - Note XS326 - Note XS351 - Note 15 - Note XS342 - Note 130 - Note XS347 - Note XS327 - Note XS345 - Note XS344 - Note XS328 - Note XS352 - Note XS353	12.2
170(i)	Calcium carbonate	GMP	- Note XS326 - Note XS351	12.2.1

INS No. ▼	Food Additive or Group	Max Level ▼	Notes ▼	Defined In ▼
			Note 534	
552	Calcium silicate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
	ETHYLENE DIAMINE TETRA ACETATES	70 mg/kg	Note XS343 Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 21 Note XS342 Note XS347 Note XS327 Note XS345 Note XS344 Note XS328 Note XS352 Note XS353	12.2
1442	Hydroxypropyl distarch phosphate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
953	Isomalt (Hydrogenated isomaltulose)	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
504(i)	Magnesium carbonate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
504(ii)	Magnesium hydroxide carbonate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
530	Magnesium oxide	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
553(i)	Magnesium silicate, synthetic	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
470(iii)	Magnesium stearate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
421	Mannitol	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
1205	Methacrylate copolymer, basic (BMC)	GMP	Note XS343 Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 608 Note XS342 Note XS347 Note XS327 Note XS345 Note XS344 Note XS328 Note 606 Note XS352 Note XS353	12.2.1
460(i)	Microcrystalline cellulose (Cellulose gel)	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
	POLYSORBATES	2,000 mg/kg	Note XS343 Note XS326 Note XS351 Note XS342 Note XS347 Note XS327 Note XS345 Note XS344 Note XS328	12.2.1

INS No. ▼	Food Additive or Group	Max Level ▼	Notes ▼	Defined In ▼
			☐ Note XS352 ☐ Note XS353	
460(ii)	Powdered cellulose	GMP	☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note 534	12.2.1
310	Propyl gallate	200 mg/kg	☐ Note XS343 ☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note 15 ☐ Note XS342 ☐ Note 130 ☐ Note XS347 ☐ Note XS327 ☐ Note XS345 ☐ Note XS344 ☐ Note XS328 ☐ Note XS352 ☐ Note XS353	12.2
	SORBATES	1,000 mg/kg	☐ Note XS343 ☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note XS342 ☐ Note XS347 ☐ Note XS327 ☐ Note XS345 ☐ Note XS344 ☐ Note XS328 ☐ Note 42 ☐ Note XS352 ☐ Note XS353	12.2
	SUCROSE ESTERS	2,000 mg/kg	☐ Note XS343 ☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note XS342 ☐ Note XS347 ☐ Note XS327 ☐ Note XS345 ☐ Note XS344 ☐ Note 422 ☐ Note XS328 ☐ Note XS352 ☐ Note XS353	12.2.1
	SULFITES	150 mg/kg	☐ Note XS343 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note XS342 ☐ Note XS347 ☐ Note 532 ☐ Note XS327 ☐ Note XS345 ☐ Note 44 ☐ Note XS344 ☐ Note 652 ☐ Note XS328 ☐ Note XS352 ☐ Note XS353	12.2.1
470(i)	Salts of myristic, palmitic and stearic acids with ammonia, calcium, potassium and sodium	GMP	☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note 534	12.2.1
470(ii)	Salts of oleic acid with calcium, potassium and sodium	GMP	☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note 534	12.2.1
551	Silicon dioxide, amorphous	GMP	☐ Note XS326 ☐ Note 51 ☐ Note XS351 ☐ Note 534	12.2.1
500(i)	Sodium carbonate	GMP	☐ Note XS326	12.2.1

INS No. ▼	Food Additive or Group	Max Level ▼	Notes ▼	Defined In ▼
			Note XS351 Note 534	
500(ii)	Sodium hydrogen carbonate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
500(iii)	Sodium sesquicarbonate	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
	TOCOPHEROLS	2,000 mg/kg	Note XS343 Note XS326 Note XS351 Note XS342 Note 421 Note XS347 Note XS327 Note XS345 Note XS344 Note XS328 Note XS352 Note XS353	12.2
553(iii)	Talc	GMP	Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 534	12.2.1
319	Tertiary butylhydroquinone (TBHQ)	200 mg/kg	Note XS343 Note XS326 Note XS351 Note 15 Note XS342 Note 130 Note XS347 Note XS327 Note XS345 Note XS344 Note XS328 Note XS352 Note XS353	12.2

Items in uppercase (e.g. **PHOSPHATES**) refer to food additive groups.

 [printer-friendly version](#)

[GSFA Home](#) [Food Categories](#) [Food Additives](#) [Search](#) [Functional Classes](#) [Glossary](#)

© FAO and WHO 2026